

Official User Manual — Narrando v1.0.0

Comprehensive Guide to Narrative Design, Structure, Screenwriting, and Cinematic Pre-Production

Welcome to **Narrando (v1.0.0)**, the cinematic authoring and narrative design environment engineered to empower every phase of storytelling: from the initial spark of an idea to the final delivery of industry-standard screenplays and executive production breakdowns.

This manual is written specifically for **screenwriters, novelists, showrunners, directors, and producers**. Across these pages, you will discover how to articulate your story universe, calibrate dramatic rhythm and tension, write continuously with zero friction, and surgically audit every creative and logistical element of your project.

PART I: CORE FOUNDATIONS & WORKSPACE

1. The Narrando Philosophy: BEING, BECOMING, and MANUSCRIPT

Most writing software forces authors into an artificial compromise: either a rigid text document where structural perspective is lost, or a disconnected board of index cards where literary cadence dissolves.

Narrando eliminates this friction through a creative trinity powered by the **Soft Sync** paradigm:

-  **BEING (Domain of Existence — The Story Universe)**: The timeless conceptual map of your narrative universe. Here reside characters, locations, key props, factions, and dynamic relationships.
-  **BECOMING (Domain of Sequence — 2D Causal Board)**: The temporal canvas where events unfold chronologically. It governs cause-and-effect progression, step outlining, Act and Sequence structures, and the dramatic tension curve.
-  **MANUSCRIPT (Domain of Writing — 1D Screenplay Canvas)**: Continuous literary composition in industry-standard typography. Write dialogue, action lines, and scene headings with total focus and flow.

 **Note — The Soft Sync Principle**: What you write in the Manuscript seamlessly informs the Outline; what you reorganize on the Causal Board instantly reorders the

Manuscript; and entities created in the world are immediately available for intelligent autocompletion as you type. Neither layer gets in the way of the other.

1.1. BEING: The Domain of Existence (The Story Universe & Its Elements)

The domain of **BEING** is the conceptual map of your universe, free from chronological constraints. This is where your characters, locations, key objects, factions, and relationship networks live.

- In this space, entities exist on their own terms and interconnect via logical relationships (family ties, hierarchies, geography, alliances, or rivalry).
- It allows you to design your project's "Story Bible" before, during, or after plotting the storyline.

1.2. BECOMING: The Domain of Temporal Sequence & Causality

The domain of **BECOMING** is where events occur across time.

- It governs causal progression: how an inciting incident in scene one triggers a crisis at the midpoint and resolves in the climax.
- It is the territory of the **step outline**, distribution across **Acts and Sequences**, and the modulation of the **Dramatic Tension Curve**.
- Every atomic unit here is an **Action**: the minimal unit of dramatic transformation.

1.3. MANUSCRIPT: The Domain of Continuous Literary Writing

The **MANUSCRIPT** is the canvas where the story is read and experienced as a finished piece of cinematic writing.

- It provides a distraction-free writing environment formatted in industry-standard typography (Courier Prime).
- It enables you to focus on the pacing of action, subtext in dialogue, and atmosphere, while the underlying causal engine preserves background structure.

2. Project Portal & Initial Setup

Project management and setup start at the **Project Portal** (Welcome Gate), engineered to guarantee privacy, local autonomy, and file integrity.

The portal is organized into two primary columns with a language selector in the upper corner:

1. **Creation Column (New Project):**

- Register your **Project Title** and **Author / Creator Name**.
- Clicking **Create Project** opens your native system file explorer, allowing you to choose the exact local directory for your master **.escx** project file.
- The system initializes a clean workspace and automatically records a protected baseline snapshot called **Genesis** in the Time Machine vault.

2. Management Column (Existing & Recent Projects):

- **Open Local File:** Open any existing **.escx** project from your computer. Narrando requires no mandatory cloud accounts or external servers; your creative work remains 100% private on your machine.
- **Recent Projects List:** One-click access to recently opened projects.
- **Duplicate Project (📋):** Quick-action button beside each recent project that creates an exact clone on your machine—ideal for branching out alternative drafts ("*Director's Cut*", "*Pitch Draft*") before undertaking major rewrites.

3. Global Language Switcher:

- Toggle between **Spanish (ES)** and **English (EN)** in the upper right corner at any time.

3. Interface Anatomy: Top Toolbar & Sovereign Navigation

The top **Toolbar** spans the top of your workspace, unifying navigation and essential controls into three clear zones:

3.1. Left Zone: State & Universal Search

- **Project Identity:** Displays the active screenplay title and registered author.
- **Persistence Indicator (Save Status):** Shows whether all changes are committed to disk (✓ **Saved**) or if background writes are actively processing.
- **Global Command Palette (Ctrl + K):** Universal spotlight search to jump instantly to any scene, character, location, or invoke commands without lifting your hands from the keyboard.

3.2. Center Zone: Workspaces, Production & History

- **Workspace Switcher:**
 - **MANUSCRIPT:** Pure continuous text view for screenwriting and reading flow.
 - **BOARD (BECOMING):** 2D infinite spatial canvas of dramatic actions, causal links, and step outline.
 - **ONTOLOGY (BEING):** Visual worldbuilding map for characters, locations, and lore.

- **DUAL:** Horizontal split-screen view to work in tandem (Board on top, Ontology below) with an adjustable divider.
- **MACHINA ANALYTICA:** Dedicated live analytics dashboard, cast balance, and production metrics.
- **Production Status & Script Lock Badge (🔒 Script Lock):**
 - Displays whether the screenplay is in open developmental writing (*Unlocked*) or frozen for pre-production and filming (*Locked*).
 - Clicking the badge opens the production panel to toggle lock state, inspect the **Active Revision Tier** (with its industry-standard color indicator: White, Blue, Pink, Yellow, Green, etc.), and advance to the next revision tier when distributing production page revisions.
- **History Controls & Vault:**
 - **Undo (Ctrl + Z) and Redo (Ctrl + Shift + Z):** Instantly step backward or forward through your recent edits.
 - **Time Machine Vault (⌚ Time Machine):** Central hub for historical milestones and full-project snapshots to revisit any key draft.
 - **X-Ray Dropdown (X-Ray):** Dropdown menu to jump back precisely to recent edit steps.
- **Auxiliary Panel Toggles:**
 - Quick toggles to show or hide the **Linear Editor** (left dock), **Inspector** (right dock), and **Timeline** (bottom drawer).

3.3. Right Zone: Filters, AI, Export & Settings

- **Global Command Palette (Ctrl + K / Cmd + K):** Central operations hub. Instantly switch between workspaces (**MANUSCRIPT**, **BECOMING**, **BEING**, **DUAL**), trigger analysis & AI tools (**BREAK DOWN PROJECT**, **SCRIPT DOCTOR**, **EXTRACT ENTITIES**, **MACHINA ANALYTICA**), or search through scenes and story entities in real-time with keyboard navigation.
- **DEVENIR Search & Filtering System:**
 - **Contextual Search (Ctrl + F):** On 2D spatial canvases (**BECOMING**, **BEING**, **DUAL**), invokes the search bar to filter actions and scenes on the Causal Board and Timeline. In the **Manuscript**, it respects your writing flow by transparently delegating to the browser's native text search.
 - **Entity & Taxonomy Filter Catalog (Layers Icon):** Dropdown menu featuring an **integrated search box**, live appearance counters for each entity across the screenplay, and visibility toggles for the SER ontology canvas (eye icon). Automatically filters out unassigned entities to minimize visual clutter. Filtering operates sovereignly within DEVENIR without locking or constraining the conceptual SER canvas.
- **AI Creative Assistants:** Provider configuration and direct access to 🧠 **Script Doctor** (dramatic tension audit) and ✨ **Assisted Breakdown**.
- **Export Wizard (📦 Export):** 3-step intention-based export assistant for industry formats (PDF, FDX, Fountain, CSV, etc.).
- **On-Screen Guidance (💡 Tips) & Pedagogical Tooltip System:** Toggle helpful explanatory popovers on or off when hovering over interface tools. When active, hovering over workspace switchers (**MANUSCRIPT**, **FLOW**, **BEING**, **DUAL**, **MACHINA ANALYTICA**) displays deep pedagogical definitions explaining each creative domain,

- presented in high-readability Ghost Zinc AAA styling.
- **Global Language Selector:** Instantly toggle between **Spanish (ES)** and **English (EN)** across all screens.
- **Universal Modal Navigation:** All modals and confirmation dialogs reliably dismiss upon pressing the **Escape** key or clicking outside their boundary, and confirm with **Enter**.

3.4. Actionable Empty States & Seamless Onboarding

Narrando prevents "blank canvas" intimidation through interactive, instructional empty states across each creative space:

- **Ontology Canvas (BEING):** When the canvas has no placed nodes and the library contains no entities, an instructional card introduces the timeless universe map along with a primary **"Create First Entity"** button that opens the entity modal directly. If entities already exist in the library, the canvas stays clear and welcoming for drag-and-drop workflow.
- **Machina Analytica:** When the story is empty, the workspace presents an educational breakdown of available narrative telemetry and includes a **"Write First Action"** call-to-action button, which automatically routes the user to the Manuscript and primes the text cursor.
- **Accessibility (A11y) Shielding:** Inactive workspaces are rendered inert using the native HTML **inert** attribute, guaranteeing that keyboard **Tab** navigation never gets trapped in invisible background components.

4. The Quad-Dock Modular System

Flanking the central canvas, Narrando introduces the **Quad-Dock System**: four independently configurable docking quadrants (Left Top/Bottom and Right Top/Bottom) that allow you to tailor your workstation to your current task.

Each quadrant features a dropdown selector in its header to instantly switch between **9 Specialized Modular Widgets**:

Widget	Primary Function	Ideal Use Case
Draft Revisions	Script version history, visual comparison tool, and sandbox rescue.	Compare your current script against earlier drafts, review additions and cuts line by line, and rescue discarded lines.
Marginalia & Notes	Scratchpad for quick ideas and margin notes.	Capture spontaneous thoughts, rewrite reminders, or production notes without

Widget	Primary Function	Ideal Use Case
		altering scene order or estimated runtime.
Inspector Lite	Compact property sheet for the active action or scene.	Quickly adjust dramatic tension scores (0 to 100) and tag characters on the fly while typing.
Linear Editor	Vertical continuous list of scenes and actions with drag handles.	Reorder the chronological sequence of the narrative by dragging blocks vertically.
Entity Library	Categorized catalog of characters, locations, props, and factions.	Browse character bios and drag assets onto the board or manuscript.
Machina Analytica	Real-time telemetry of screenplay proportions, density, and Day/Night balance.	Monitor the pacing of the active scene as you draft.
Script Doctor Widget	Live feed of AI diagnostic warnings and rhythm pacing alerts.	View tension drop warnings and click " <i>Focus</i> " to jump straight to the offending scene.
Fossils (Fossil)	Source text reference viewer and production omitted scene quarantine (Morgue).	Cross-reference original source material (Top Zone) and inspect or restore omitted scenes in quarantine during production with a single click (Bottom Morgue Zone).
Sandbox (Holding Bay)	Holding space for shelved actions or scene variations.	Keep discarded lines, alternate punchlines, or tentative scenes safely preserved without affecting your timeline.

 **Tip:** Each side of the Quad-Dock includes an exterior edge toggle tab to collapse or expand the entire sidebar with a single click or keyboard shortcut, granting 100% full-width immersion for deep writing sessions. Furthermore, if you wish to view a widget using **100% of the sidebar's vertical height** (ideal for extensive lists in the *Linear Editor*, full-length comparisons in *Draft Revisions*, or browsing the *Entity Library*), simply set the complementary slot (top or bottom) to **"Empty Slot"**, allowing the active widget to automatically expand to fill the entire

available vertical space.

PART II: THE THREE CREATIVE CANVASES

5. The Causal Board (BECOMING)

The **Causal Board (BECOMING)** is an infinite 2D canvas where your story's events are plotted, linked, and visualized. Here, narrative structure behaves as an elastic, relational network.

5.1 Smart Paste and Drag Reparenting

- **Smart Paste:** When duplicating (**Ctrl + D**) or pasting nodes (**Ctrl + V**), the geometric engine calculates available space and positions the new cards seamlessly, avoiding overlaps and maintaining board clarity.
- **Hierarchical Reparenting:** Freely dragging an Action card and dropping it over a Scene card automatically assigns the action to that scene (Reparenting), instantly recalculating the dramatic tension of the parent block.
- **Automatic Camera Centering:** When selecting or focusing any action card from search or switching perspectives, the spatial camera smoothly frames the card at the center of the board, maintaining clear orientation without tedious manual panning.

5.2 Causal Connections

On the Causal Board, story causality is established by dragging connector lines from the circular connection points on card edges: number, synoptic body text, **Dramatic Tension Score (0 to 100)**, and its **Sandbox Toggle (II)**. Cards connect via directional causal lines that trace the story's consequence chains.

5.3. The Atomic Unit: The Action

An **Action** is the minimal unit of dramatic transformation in Narrando. It is not merely a block of text, but an event with dramatic weight, estimated duration, and ripple effects across the plot.

Three intuitive ways to create an Action:

1. **Top Bar "+ Action" Button:** Appends a new action at the first available chronological slot in the step outline.
2. **Context Menu (Right-click anywhere on the canvas):**
 - **Create in Sandbox:** Generates a free-floating action, perfect for capturing raw ideas that do not yet have a defined chronological place.

- **Create Ordered:** Inserts an action directly integrated into the timeline sequence at that exact spatial coordinate.
3. **Keyboard Shortcut (Ctrl + N):** Instantly summons a new action subordinate to the active scene.

5.4. Sandbox Mode (Shelved Actions & Variations)

Each action card features a **Sandbox Button** () in its header. Toggling it:

- Detaches the action into an "unbound / paused" state: it drops out of the chronological sequence, disappears from the Timeline Tension Curve, and does not add to estimated script runtime.
- **Sandbox Use Cases:**
 - Preserving alternate dialogue, endings, or jokes without deleting them.
 - Brainstorming tentative scene ideas during writers' room sessions.
 - Holding B-plots and subplots in reserve until they mature.
- **Reintegration:** To restore an action from the Sandbox into the active narrative, click **Sandbox** again; the system re-indexes it into the chronological sequence based on its board coordinate.

5.5. The Law of Natural Expansion

To prevent clutter and overlapping cards as your story expands to dozens or hundreds of scenes, the board organizes space intelligently:

- When you expand or drag an action card downward, the system **smoothly glides down** all actions and groups positioned below it.
- This ensures that your scene columns never overlap or cover one another, always preserving clean breathing room to write or insert new actions comfortably.

5.6. Scene Groups & Multi-Selection

Selecting multiple cards (via marquee drag selection or **Shift + Click**) and right-clicking unlocks collective tools:

- **Group:** Wraps the selected actions inside a container frame with an editable title. Moving the group container shifts all child actions together.
- **Color Categorization:** Simultaneously applies one of the 8 project palette colors across all selected cards.
- **Unified Deletion:** Choose between *Ungroup* (remove the bounding frame while preserving all actions in place) or *Delete* (remove the entire block from the outline).

5.7. Assisted Writing & Ghost Text Suggestions on 2D Cards

When drafting directly inside any action card on the spatial board:

- **Automatic Text Suggestions (Ghost Text):** As you begin typing a character name,

location, or scene heading (such as **INT .**), the system immediately displays a faint gray suggestion to the right of your cursor.

- **Autocompletion with the Tab Key:** Press **Tab** to accept the suggestion instantly. If multiple options match (for instance, several characters whose names begin with the same letter), press **Tab** repeatedly to cycle through available choices smoothly without lifting your hands from the keyboard.
 - **Lag-Free Instant Typing:** Text editing inside 2D cards operates instantaneously; every keystroke updates in real time with zero latency or performance dips across the infinite canvas.
-

6. The Ontology Canvas (BEING)

The domain of **BEING** is the space dedicated to worldbuilding, relational mapping, and the underlying mythology of your story.

On this canvas, universe components (characters, locations, key props, factions, and concepts) are represented as interactive nodes connected by logical and thematic relationships.

6.1. Entities & Archetypes

In the Ontology Canvas, world elements are categorized across 5 primary archetypes:

-  **Characters:** Protagonists, antagonists, supporting cast, and background figures.
-  **Locations:** Primary sets, fictional realms, interiors, and exteriors.
-  **Objects:** Key props, *MacGuffins*, weapons, documents, and relics.
-  **Factions:** Organizations, families, corporations, or clans.
-  **Concepts / Tags:** Thematic motifs, emotional arcs, or symbolic codes.

6.2. The Immersive Entity Sheet

Double-clicking any entity (on the canvas or in the side library) opens its comprehensive **Entity Sheet**:

- **Dynamic Descriptions:** The panel automatically adapts its fields to the asset type ("*Biography*" for Characters, "*Setting Description*" for Locations, "*Physical Properties*" for Objects).
- **Aliases & Nicknames:** Register alternate monikers (e.g., "*The Stranger*", "*Doc*", "*Central Precinct*") that the system leverages for autocomplete while drafting and in automated script breakdowns.
- **Custom Attributes:** Descriptive fields to track age, profession, motivations, flaws, or coordinates.
- **Scene Appearance Log:** Displays a complete list of every scene where the entity appears. If a scene lacks a title, the engine generates an intelligent reference snippet based on its opening action.

6.3. Seamless Navigation between Universe and Scenes

Narrando connects worldbuilding directly with active script drafting:

- Clicking any scene listed under the **Appearances** section of an Entity Sheet closes the window and **smoothly centers the camera** on that exact scene on the Causal Board or in the Manuscript.
- If you are in pure Ontology view, the interface automatically switches to **DUAL** mode so you can view the scene in time without losing your world context.

6.4. Entity Merging (Duplicate Resolution)

If duplicate entities were created during fast writing or imports (e.g., "*Viktor*" and "*Viktor Petrov*"):

1. Select the duplicate entities in the library or canvas and click **Merge Entities**.
2. Designate the **Primary Entity**, which retains its canonical name, archetype, and biography.
3. The system re-routes all dialogue, appearances, and causal links from the secondary entities to the primary entity, cleanly deleting duplicates without data loss.

6.5. Color Taxonomy Manager

Accessible from the BEING toolbar, the **Color Tag Manager** lets you rename and customize the narrative meaning of the system's 8 palette colors (e.g., assigning Blue to "*Romantic Subplot*", Red to "*High Danger / Climax*", or Green to "*Northern Faction*").

6.6. Contextual & Safe Entity Deletion

When pressing **Del** or **Delete** on an entity (or triggering its deletion from the lore library), Narrando opens the **Unified Delete Modal**, designed with contextual intelligence to protect story data:

- **Remove from Canvas (Soft Delete):** Removes the entity's visual representation from the ontology canvas, but keeps its character card, backstory, traits, and occurrences across the Manuscript and Causal Board completely intact.
 - **Delete from Project (Hard Delete):** Permanently removes the entity from the entire project lore and unlinks it from all scenes.
 - **Library Context Awareness:** If the chosen entity **only exists in the library** and has never been dropped onto the canvas, the system automatically detects this state and **hides the "Remove from Canvas" option**, clearly explaining that the action will permanently delete the entity from the project.
 - **Keyboard Navigation:** Pressing **Enter** automatically commits the safest available action (Soft Delete if placed on the canvas; Hard Delete if only in the library). Pressing **Escape** or clicking outside immediately cancels the operation.
-

7. The Manuscript Canvas & Print Preview

The **Manuscript Canvas** is Narrando's literary core: a continuous writing environment where your screenplay unfolds as an industry-standard script with real-time formatting.

At the top of the editor, a floating toolbar houses your focus tools: the **Zen Writer (Focus Mode)** toggle, the continuous scene numbering toggle (#), the **Print Preview** button () , the **Lexical Focus** selector, the **Cast Focus** dropdown, a live page count estimator (PGS), and a physical page format toggle (A4) / (LETTER).

7.1. Cinematic Typography & Industry Standards

The manuscript adheres strictly to international film industry standards (monospaced Courier Prime). Scene headings, action lines, character names, parentheticals, dialogue blocks, and transitions are formatted with automatic indentation and margins.

7.2. Writing Dynamics & Keyboard Shortcuts

The Manuscript writing experience is engineered for maximum speed and focus, allowing you to structure your story without lifting your hands from the keyboard:

- **Enter:** Creates a new Action (paragraph) within the active scene.
- **Backspace:** When at the beginning of an empty paragraph, pressing Backspace smoothly merges the cursor into the preceding Action without disrupting structural order or scene indices.
- **Ctrl + Enter (Cmd + Enter):** Instantly creates and jumps into a brand-new Scene immediately following the current one.
- **Zen Writer (Focus Mode):** Clicking the focus icon on the top toolbar smoothly and reactively collapses all peripheral panels (sidebar docks, bottom Timeline, and right Inspector). The drafting area centers into an optimal ergonomic column, providing an immersive writing experience free from visual distractions.

7.3. Intelligent Autocomplete and Entity Creation

As you write, Narrando accelerates your typing speed without requiring mouse interaction:

- **Automatic Sluglines:** Typing the first letters of a line brings up standard prefixes (INT., EXT., INT/EXT., EST.). Pressing **Tab** completes the slugline immediately.
- **Time-of-Day Tokens:** Typing a hyphen after a location prompts canonical time tokens (DAY, NIGHT, DAWN, DUSK, CONTINUOUS).
- **New Term Recognition:** If you type an unconventional time token (e.g., "GOLDEN HOUR", "MIDNIGHT"), the system automatically registers it for future autocomplete suggestions.
- **Character Dialogue:** Typing a character's name in uppercase triggers instant autocomplete; pressing **Enter** centers the cursor for immediate dialogue input.
- **Floating Menu Navigation:** When autocomplete suggestions appear, use the ↑ and ↓

arrow keys to cycle between options, press **Enter** or **Tab** to confirm, or press **Escape** to dismiss the menu.

- **On-the-fly Creation:** When typing a new character's name or triggering the menu with **@**, if the entity does not exist in the catalog, you can press **Enter** on the suggestion to instantly create it in the Ontology without interrupting your writing flow.

7.4. Lexical Focus (Structural Reading Modes)

The **Lexical Focus** selector in the Manuscript toolbar lets you isolate specific storytelling layers:

- **Full Document:** Standard complete view of the screenplay.
- **Dialogue Only:** Hides all action lines, allowing writers to audit dialogue flow, voice distinctiveness, and conversational cadence in one pass.
- **Action Only:** Hides dialogue to evaluate visual rhythm, physical choreography, and cinematic imagery.
- **Sluglines Only:** Displays only scene headings and times (skeleton outline view).

7.5. Cast Focus (Actor Isolation Mode)

The **Cast Focus** menu allows you to isolate a specific character (e.g., "*JOHN*").

- The manuscript dims or filters out scenes where the selected character does not appear, bringing their specific lines and actions into sharp focus.
- Indispensable for table reads, actor rehearsals, and character arc consistency audits.

7.6. Quick Text Menu (Create Assets on the Fly)

Selecting any text snippet in the manuscript or on the 2D action cards (such as a new prop like "*THE ANTIQUE POCKET WATCH*" or an unlisted character) displays a clean floating **+ ENTITY** button. Clicking it lets you catalog the asset into your story universe without breaking your writing flow. To dismiss the selection and hide the button, simply press **Escape** or click outside the selected text.

7.7. Print Preview & Native Output (Actual Page Layout)

Clicking the printer icon () in the Manuscript header switches to the dedicated **Print Preview Workspace**:

- **Real-Time Accurate Pagination:** Computes exact physical page pagination in the background without delays or interruptions.
- **1:1 PDF Fidelity:** Accurately renders physical page sheets with page numbers, **CHARACTER (CONT'D)** continuation headers, and **(MORE)** continuation footers for split dialogues.
- **Native One-Click Printing:** The toolbar features a dedicated **Print** () button that triggers the operating system's native print dialog. This allows authors to send the script directly to a physical printer or generate a clean PDF adhering to standard Courier Prime screenplay margins and page breaks.

- **Seamless Editor Return:** The ← **Back** button smoothly returns you to continuous manuscript editing while preserving your exact reading and cursor position.
 - **One-Click Format Switch:** Toggle between **A4** and **Letter** formats at any time, instantly recalculating pagination on-screen and updating your final export configuration.
-

PART III: AI INTELLIGENCE & NARRATIVE TELEMETRY

8. Artificial Intelligence Assistants

Narrando incorporates natural language processing assistants engineered not to generate generic placeholder text, but to serve as **rhythm and pacing auditors and mechanical workflow accelerators**.

8.1. Script Doctor (Dramatic Tension Audit)

The **Script Doctor** audits the dramatic progression of the entire screenplay. When triggered via the  button on the top toolbar:

- It reads the chronological sequence of actions and calculates a conflict and emotional intensity score (0 to 100) for each.
- It plots the **Dramatic Tension Curve** across the Timeline.
- It produces a structured qualitative report highlighting pacing valleys, flat stretches, and climax intensity.
- **Live Progress Tracking & Safe Cancellation:** During the audit, a progress window displays scene-by-scene analysis. You can click **Cancel** at any time; the interface recovers instantly while retaining all analysis completed up to that point.

8.2. Assisted Scene Breakdown

Selecting a dense block of prose or an imported scene and clicking **Break Down**:

- The AI segments long paragraphs into clear dramatic action cards based on cause-and-effect beats.
- Choose between three distinct modes:
 - **Structural Mode:** High-level summary ideal for outline treatments.
 - **Atomic Mode:** Step-by-step breakdown into pure dramatic actions (one key event per card).
 - **Custom Mode:** Allows you to provide specific instructions on how you want the text divided.

8.3. Mass Entity Extraction

When importing existing screenplays or prose treatments, the extraction assistant scans the entire text to identify characters, locations, and key objects:

- **Match Preview:** Displays a clear occurrence count for each suggested element.
- **Intelligent Global Assignment:** Automatically links confirmed characters across every scene where they are mentioned, normalizing casing, abbreviations, and spelling variations.

8.4. AI Setup: Cloud vs. Local

Narrando grants complete freedom of choice between **Cloud-based AI Assistants** (Google Gemini, OpenAI, Claude) and **Autonomous Local AI running directly on your computer** (Ollama). Both architectures provide unique benefits tailored to your confidentiality, budget, and hardware priorities:

8.4.1. Cloud-Based Models (Google Gemini, OpenAI GPT, Anthropic Claude)

Cloud models run on high-performance remote servers and connect to Narrando via your personal API Key.

The **AI Setup** window organizes remote services into dedicated tabs featuring tools tailored for straightforward and secure management:

- **Credential Protection (👁️):** The API key field features a visibility toggle (eye icon) to inspect or mask your credentials with total discretion.
- **Live Connection Testing:** The **"Validate & Save"** button immediately verifies connectivity and model readiness before storing your credentials, providing clear status notices directly inside the setup dialog.
- **Advantages:**
 - **Instant Speed:** Lightning-fast responses in seconds even when analyzing full feature-length screenplays.
 - **Zero Hardware Strain:** Your computer performs no heavy processing; Narrando runs just as smoothly on an ultra-light laptop as on a powerful desktop.
 - **Cutting-Edge Literary Nuance:** Access to the world's most advanced language models ([gemini-1.5-pro](#), [gpt-4o](#), [claude-3-5-sonnet](#)), capable of analyzing subtle thematic arcs and complex subplots across hundreds of pages.
- **Disadvantages:**
 - **Requires Active Internet:** Inoperable during flights, remote location shooting, or network outages.
 - **Usage-Based Costs:** Requires creating an account with your chosen provider (though platforms like Google Gemini offer generous free tiers).
 - **Data Transmission:** Scene text is securely transmitted in encrypted form to the

provider's servers for analysis.

8.4.2. Autonomous Local Models (Ollama)

Ollama allows you to download and run artificial intelligence directly on your own computer, without sending any text to external servers or relying on an internet connection.

- **Advantages:**
 - **100% Privacy & Confidentiality (Zero Data Leaks):** Not a single word of your script, character secrets, or plot outlines ever leaves your machine. This is the ideal solution for projects protected by strict Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs), studio commissions, or writers who value absolute privacy.
 - **Completely Offline:** Works anywhere in the world with zero internet connectivity.
 - **100% Free & Unlimited:** No monthly subscriptions, no usage meters, and no surprise charges. Audit your story as many times as you like at zero cost.
- **Disadvantages:**
 - **Speed Depends on Your Hardware:** Processing speed depends entirely on your computer's processor and graphics card. On standard computers, local analysis can take noticeably longer than cloud queries.
 - **Disk Space Footprint:** Each downloaded model consumes between 2 GB and 8 GB of storage on your computer.
 - **System Memory:** Larger models require sufficient RAM and graphics memory to run smoothly.

8.4.3. Comparative Matrix: Cloud AI vs. Local AI

Feature	Cloud Assistants (Gemini / OpenAI / Claude)	Local Assistant on Your Computer (Ollama)
Script Privacy	Good (encrypted during transmission to provider).	Absolute (text never leaves your hard drive).
Internet Requirement	Permanent active internet required.	100% Offline (internet needed only for initial download).
Cost of Use	Variable based on provider and volume.	Free & Unlimited forever.
Response Speed	Ultra-fast (high-powered remote servers).	Moderate to slow (depends on your computer's power).
Impact on Computer	Zero (no extra memory or	High (requires local disk

Feature	Cloud Assistants (Gemini / OpenAI / Claude)	Local Assistant on Your Computer (Ollama)
	graphics load).	space and available system memory).
Analytical Depth	Maximum frontier intelligence available.	Very good for scene analysis, outlines, and character tracking.
Best Suited For...	Writers who prioritize blazing speed and instant feedback.	Writers with confidential projects, writers on the go, or zero-budget setups.

8.4.4. Step-by-Step Guide: Easy Ollama Management in Narrando

To configure and run local AI entirely from within the application, open the **AI Settings** menu (click  on the top toolbar) and select **Ollama**:

1. One-Click Local Engine Installation:

- If Ollama is not installed on your computer, a button labeled **Install Ollama Engine** will appear. Clicking it automatically downloads and sets up the engine.
- Once ready, the panel will display **Engine detected and ready**.
- Click **Check** at any time to verify whether a newer release is available.
- **Uninstall**: If you choose to stop using local AI, an inline **Uninstall Engine** button allows you to remove it cleanly with one click.

2. Selecting Models for Your Story Workflow: Narrando provides curated downloads tailored to specific creative tasks:

- **Qwen 2.5:**
 - *Recommended for:* Fast scene summaries, structural outlining, and lightweight action breakdowns.
 - *Suggested specs:* **RAM: 2GB+ | Graphics Memory: 1.5GB.**
 - *Storage footprint:* ~2.0 GB.
- **Mistral (7B):**
 - *Recommended for:* The **Script Doctor** deep conflict audit, thematic analysis, and pacing diagnostics.
 - *Suggested specs:* **RAM: 8GB+ | Graphics Memory: 6GB.**
 - *Storage footprint:* ~4.4 GB.
- **Other Models from the Library:**
 - To explore additional models (such as [llama3.2](#), [phi3](#), or [deepseek-r1:1.5b](#)), click **Browse library** ↗ (ollama.com/library), enter the model name in the input box, and click **Download**.

3. Managing and Maintaining Models:

- **Cancel Download:** If you need to stop a download in progress, click **Cancel** to abort the transfer immediately.
- **Ready to Use:** As soon as a download reaches 100%, the model is instantly activated and ready for your projects.
- **Delete and Reclaim Disk Space (🗑️):** Every installed model includes a trashcan icon. Clicking it and confirming immediately deletes the model to free up storage space on your hard drive.

9. Machina Analytica & Dramatic Pacing Metrics

The **Machina Analytica** (📊) panel delivers a comprehensive quantitative x-ray of your story without interrupting your creative momentum. Its interface is organized into three dedicated tabs:

- **Core Metrics:** Displays essential structural benchmarks: estimated screen runtime, total actions and scenes, overall word count, environmental set balance (Interior vs. Exterior), and lighting distribution (Day vs. Night).
- **Lexical Metrics:** Audits the script's literary fabric: dialogue versus action description ratios, estimated reading speed, speech volume per character, and vocabulary richness.
- **Narrative Tags & Smart Queries:** Allows writers and story editors to explore the narrative through thematic tags, plot motifs, and character archetypes, auditing their recurrence across Acts and Sequences.

Analytical Dimension	Key Indicators	Practical Utility for Writers & Producers
Script Volume	Total actions, word count, estimated runtime.	Control pacing, page count, and runtime targets.
Environmental Balance	Interior vs. Exterior percentage.	Evaluate visual variety and set budget allocations.
Temporal Balance	Day vs. Night scene distribution.	Optimize shooting schedules and lighting department logistics.
Conflict Curve	Average tension, peak climaxes, and valleys.	Diagnose narrative drive and identify second-act slowdowns.
Cast Density	Global presence, relative category share, focus ratio.	Measure character screen time and balance ensemble

Analytical Dimension	Key Indicators	Practical Utility for Writers & Producers
		casts.

9.1. The Continuous Tension Curve (Timeline)

Located at the bottom of the workspace, this interactive chart plots story conflict across your narrative:

- **Horizontal Axis:** The chronological progression of the story.
- **Vertical Axis:** Dramatic intensity (0 to 100).
- **Act & Sequence Bands:** Visual markers delineating major story blocks. Dragging the outer edges of any Act or Sequence band elastically resizes its scope, automatically reassigning the scenes within its boundaries.

9.2. Heatmap Mode (Thermographic View)

Activating the 🔥 icon tints action cards on the Causal Board with a gradient corresponding to their tension score (from cool greens for decompressed scenes to fiery reds for climax peaks). Spot rhythm valleys or pacing slowdowns simply by zooming out on the board.

9.3. Density & Impact Metrics

Calculates the exact weight of each narrative asset:

- **Global Presence:** Percentage of scenes in which an entity participates relative to the entire script.
- **Relative Share:** Protagonism percentage within its own archetype (e.g., a supporting character's screen time relative to other supporting cast members).
- **Specific Focus:** Dominance ratio of the entity in scenes where it is actively present.

10. Advanced Production & Breakdown Tools

For production teams, line producers, and 1st Assistant Directors (1st ADs), Narrando provides tools that transform literary screenplays into quantified production schedules.

10.1. Breakdown Sheet

An exhaustive grid organized by scene that categorizes all production requirements:

- **Cast (Primary Talent):** Speaking roles and key action participants.
- **Extras / Atmosphere:** Background crowds and silent talent.
- **Props:** Objects handled by actors.
- **Set Dressing:** Notable background decor and scenic dressing.

- **Costume & Makeup / Hair:** Specific wardrobe and characterization needs.
- **SFX / VFX:** Physical on-set special effects and digital visual effects.
- **Sound & Music:** Practical sound effects, cues, and source music.
- **Special Equipment:** Cranes, underwater cameras, picture vehicles, or stunt rigs.

10.2. Day-out-of-Days (DOOD) Shoot Matrix

The film industry standard matrix for auditing cast member call days:

- Displays a visual schedule showing work status for every actor (**WORK / HOLD / DROP**).
- Helps spot costly dead days between calls and optimize talent booking budgets.
- Features a **Direct CSV Export (↓ CSV)** button for instant spreadsheet imports.

10.3. Workload View & Shoot Time Estimation

- Automatically calculates **Page Count and Page Eighths** for every scene.
- Estimates screen runtime and recommended shooting day durations based on location complexity and cast size.

10.4. Production Script Lock & Revision Tiers

Once a screenplay transitions into pre-production and active shooting, changing scene numbers at random can invalidate shooting schedules, departmental breakdowns, actor call sheets, and physical scripts already distributed to cast and crew.

- **Activating the Script Lock (🔒 Script Lock):** In the top toolbar, click the lock status badge to toggle the lock on. From that moment forward, scene numbers become immutable.
- **Industry Canonical Revision Tiers:** Narrando adheres to the standard color progression established by film industry production guilds (WGA / PGA):
 1. **White:** Locked shooting draft (initial production baseline).
 2. **Blue:** 1st Revision.
 3. **Pink:** 2nd Revision.
 4. **Yellow:** 3rd Revision.
 5. **Green:** 4th Revision.
 6. **Goldenrod:** 5th Revision.
 7. **Buff:** 6th Revision.
 8. **Salmon:** 7th Revision.
 9. **Cherry:** 8th Revision.
 10. **Second White:** Restart of revision color cycle.
- **Automatic Revision Tagging:** Edits and newly drafted text created during an active revision tier automatically inherit the current revision color metadata, ensuring accurate production tracking and clear visual indicators for department heads.

10.5. Alphanumeric Scene Numbering (A-Scenes / Scene Splits)

When inserting or splitting a scene within a locked screenplay (e.g., adding a scene between Scene 14 and Scene 15):

- Narrando **never shifts or rennumbers** subsequent scenes (Scene 15 will never become Scene 16).
- The engine deterministically computes an alphanumeric scene number conforming to industry standards: **14A**, **14B**, or **A1** if added prior to Scene 1.
- This shields the production office, ADs, and location managers from cascading number shifts.

10.6. Omitted Scenes Protocol and the Morgue (**OMITTED**)

When a screenplay enters production under **Script Lock** (🔒), deleting a scene physically would wreak havoc on call sheets, actor contracts, and department budgets. Narrando implements the non-destructive industry standard:

- **Automatic Deletion Interception:** If you press **Backspace** or **Delete** on a scene heading in the Manuscript or delete it from the Causal Board, the system **never destroys the scene**. Instead, it clears the text body from memory and immediately transmutes the block into an **Omitted Scene** (`data.isOmitted = true`), retaining its official production number immutably.
- **Clean 1D and 2D Invisibility:** The omitted scene and all its subordinate action cards instantly vanish from the Manuscript (without leaving blank lines, phantom paragraphs, or orphan gutter marks) and from the 2D Causal Board. Chronological ghost guide arrows dynamically skip over omitted blocks to cleanly connect adjacent active actions.
- **Exile to the Morgue (Fossils Widget):** Omitted scenes are exiled to the dedicated **Morgue** section at the bottom of the **Fossils** Quad-Dock widget. There you can monitor the real-time count badge and inspect the list of quarantined scenes.
- **One-Click In-Place Restoration:** Clicking **"Restore"** on any scene in the Morgue (or pressing **Ctrl + Z** in history) immediately revives the scene, placing it right back into its exact original position in the script and board without renumbering or displacing any other scene.
- **Production Export in PDF & FDX:** In PDF exports, the scene heading prints with the standard guild suffix **14 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - OMITTED** and suppresses all child text blocks to save page real estate. In Final Draft (.fdx) files, it receives the standard `Omitted="Yes"` production attribute.

10.7. WGA/PGA Marginal Revision Asterisks

During active production revisions, crew departments need to spot updated lines at a glance:

- **On-Demand Real-Time Diffing:** Any line containing added, edited, or deleted text relative to the frozen baseline (*Locked Baseline*) automatically displays an **asterisk (*)** in the strict right-hand margin of the page.
- **Zero Typing Latency:** Diff calculation runs asynchronously inside a background Web Worker, ensuring continuous 60 FPS typing without UI stutters.
- **Print Preview & PDF Export:** Revision asterisks are rendered identically in the **Print**

- **Preview** workspace and in final exported **PDF screenplays**.
- **Non-Cumulative Resets:** Advancing to the next revision color (via the *Advance Revision* toolbar action) clears the previous asterisks and recalibrates the baseline point for the newly active revision color.

10.8. Revision Header Strips and Production Cover Pages

- **Colored Header Strip:** On all production tiers (starting with Level 0 White and continuing through Blue, Pink, Yellow, etc.), exported PDF pages render a continuous 4 mm color stripe at the top edge with algorithmic text contrast (black or white depending on color luminance), immediately distinguishing revised physical pages on set.
- **Revision Cover Pages:** The script's title page prints with the active revision tier background color and an executive revision history table detailing dates, version labels, and author stamps.

PART IV: TIME TRAVEL, EXPORT & DELIVERY

11. The Time Machine Vault & Safe Persistence

Narrando features a comprehensive history preservation engine designed to eliminate the anxiety of data loss or accidental overwrites during deep rewrite sessions.

Status / Type	Date & Time	Description / Milestone	Available Action
 Protected	2026-08-22 - 14:30	Production Cut v1.0	Restore / Rename
 Automatic	2026-08-22 - 11:15	AI Scene Breakdown	Restore / Pin Bookmark
 Protected	2026-08-21 - 18:00	Showrunner Approved Outline	Restore / Rename
 Automatic	2026-08-20 - 09:00	Genesis (Initial Workspace)	Restore / Pin Bookmark

11.1. Self-Contained Snapshots

Unlike conventional undo buffers that only save partial text diffs, the **Time Machine** captures **complete, self-contained snapshots** of your entire project universe:

- Every snapshot preserves the exact state of the Manuscript, Causal Board, Ontology map, Marginalia notes, and Tension Curve.
- Rolling back to a previous snapshot will never desynchronize character lore from story scenes.

11.2. Automatic Snapshot Triggers

Snapshots are triggered at key narrative milestones:

1. **Genesis:** When creating any new project.
2. **Structural Milestones:** Following major operations like Script Doctor audits, bulk imports, or entity merges.
3. **Manual Save (Ctrl + S):** Whenever you consciously decide to set a project checkpoint.

11.3. Vault Management: Renaming & Pinning

Inside the Time Machine window (🕒):

- **Rename:** Click on any snapshot name to assign a meaningful label (e.g., *"Alternate Ending where Protagonist Dies"* or *"Grant Application Cut"*).
- **Pin Bookmark (📌):** Pinning a snapshot marks it as permanently protected, preventing it from being removed by automatic history cleanup routines.

11.4. The X-Ray Inspector

Located on the top Toolbar beside the Undo and Redo buttons, the **X-Ray** menu lists the exact recent edit steps performed (e.g., *"Change scene title"*, *"Assign group color"*, *"Link causal connection"*). Jump back in time with sub-second precision to any point in your current session.

11.5. Draft Revisions & Visual Comparison Tool

Alongside the project-wide Time Machine vault, Narrando embeds the **Draft Revisions** modular widget within the Quad-Dock:

- **Saved Script Revisions:** Captures frozen milestones of the screenplay with timestamp, estimated page count (**A4/US Letter**), word count, and scene metrics.
- **Automatic Session Baseline:** When opening or initiating a project, if over 12 hours have passed since the last recorded draft, the system automatically captures an initial baseline (*"Auto-Draft: Session Start"*).
- **Freeze Version Anytime:** Click **"Freeze Version"** anytime to record literary progress under a custom label (e.g., *"Completed First Draft"* or *"Act II Polish"*).
- **Visual Comparison Tool:** Clicking on any saved revision instantly compares it against your current screenplay:
 - **Additions:** Highlighted with emerald green background and text.
 - **Deletions:** Highlighted with crimson red background and text.
 - **Unchanged Lines:** Displayed in neutral tone to provide surrounding dramatic

context.

- **Viewing Modes:** Toggle between side-by-side **Split View** and continuous **Unified View**.

11.6. Rescuing Deleted Text to Sandbox (Rescue to Sandbox 🛟)

While reviewing an earlier draft in the comparison view:

- Every deleted or cut text passage features a dedicated **"Rescue to Sandbox (🛟)"** action button.
- Clicking it instantly revives that text block as a paused action card on the 2D Causal Board, positioned cleanly beside the active scene.
- This allows total freedom to cut and experiment: brilliant lines of dialogue or abandoned scene angles can be retrieved with a single click without destabilizing the timeline.
- **Full Draft Restoration:** If you choose to revert the entire screenplay to an earlier revision, the **"Restore Draft"** button cleanly recovers the complete manuscript following a safety confirmation prompt.

12. The 3-Step Export Wizard

The **Export Wizard** (🗑️ **Export**) consolidates all delivery paths into a guided, intention-driven flow:

Pipeline: Step 1: Dramatic Intention → Step 2: Scope & Format → Step 3: Metadata & Title Page

12.1. Step 1: Intention Selection

Choose the primary purpose of your exported document:

1. 🎬 **Screenplay (Literary Script):** Exports the manuscript formatted to international industry standards.
2. 📋 **Structural Step Outline:** Exports scene sequences, action synopses, and act divisions for development meetings.
3. 📊 **Production Breakdown:** Generates tabular breakdown sheets with all tagged elements for production heads.
4. 🌐 **Story Bible / Universe:** Exports the complete world encyclopedia of characters, locations, and factions with relational diagrams.
5. 📈 **Executive Analytics Dossier:** Generates a comprehensive analytical report with the tension curve, pacing telemetry, and cast density charts.

12.2. Step 2: Scope & Format

- **Scope:** Choose between exporting the **Full Project** or only the **Current Selection** (ideal for printing a single sequence or Act).

- **Available Formats by Intention:**
 - *Final Draft (.fdx)*: Compatible with standard industry production pipelines.
 - *Fountain (.fountain)*: Plain-text universal screenwriting format.
 - *High-Quality PDF*: Formatted in Courier Prime, ready for distribution or print.
 - *Structured Markdown (.md)*: Clean document with relational schemas.
 - *JSON Canvas (.canvas)*: Spatial mapping file for Obsidian and mind-mapping apps.
 - *CSV Sheets & Relational ZIP*: Structured spreadsheets for spreadsheet software.
 - *PNG & SVG Graphics*: High-resolution vector exports of boards and ontology maps.

12.3. Step 3: Metadata, Title Page & Production Settings

Fine-tune your document presentation, confidentiality, and production compliance:

- **Professional Title Page:** Project title, author, draft version, date, and contact information. In locked production scripts with active color tiers, the cover page automatically renders in the designated revision color with an executive revision log table.
- **Page Standards:** Standard **A4** or **US Letter** sizing.
- **Structural Options:** Include or omit scene numbers (conforming to alphanumeric *A-Scenes* in production), group container headers, and Act/Sequence division banners.
- **Dynamic Confidentiality Watermarks:**
 - Toggle the **Apply Watermark** option to stamp a clean diagonal, semi-transparent watermark across all pages of the generated PDF.
 - Customize the **Recipient Name** (e.g., "*VALENTINA GOMEZ*" or "*CAST TABLE READ COPY*"), **Copy ID** (e.g., "*COPY 01*"), and issue date.
 - Built with strict vector graphics isolation: watermarks will never interfere with Courier Prime legibility, dialogue line wraps, or revision header strips.
- **Omitted Scenes Output:** Scenes flagged as omitted print with their official number and the guild tag – **OMITTED**, suppressing all child action blocks to conserve paper and align with shoot schedules.
- **Marginal Revision Asterisks:** When exporting active revisions, the PDF automatically prints industry-standard asterisks (*) in the right margin of modified lines.

PART V: MISSION GUIDES — END-TO-END WORKFLOWS

13. Workflow 1: Creative Genesis (From Blank Canvas

to Finished Script)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. Sandbox Brainstorming → 2. 2D Causal Step Outline → 3. DUAL Worldbuilding → 4. Manuscript → 5. Script Doctor Audit → 6. Final FDX/PDF Export

Objective:

Build a screenplay from scratch, moving naturally from raw initial brainstorming to a finalized script ready for production.

Step-by-Step Guide:

- 1. Sandbox Brainstorming:**
 - Create a new project and switch to the **Causal Board (BECOMING)**.
 - Spawn multiple actions using **Create in Sandbox**. Jot down ideas, plot twists, and tentative scenes without worrying about chronological order.
- 2. Causal Plotting & Sequencing:**
 - Toggle off Sandbox mode on actions as they find their place in the narrative.
 - Draw causal connector lines to trace how early events trigger subsequent crises.
 - Create **Acts and Sequences** on the bottom Timeline to establish classic 3-Act or 5-Act story momentum.
- 3. Worldbuilding in DUAL Mode:**
 - Switch to **DUAL** view. On the bottom canvas (Ontology), build character sheets and locations as they emerge from the step outline.
- 4. Drafting in the Manuscript:**
 - Switch to **MANUSCRIPT** view. In the left Quad-Dock, activate the **Linear Editor** widget to navigate smoothly between scenes.
 - Draft scenes using automatic text suggestions to jump seamlessly between sluglines, characters, and dialogue.
- 5. Dramatic Tension Audit with Script Doctor:**
 - Run the **Script Doctor** (👨⚕️). Inspect the Tension Curve to verify that the climax hits target intensity and that the second act maintains drive.
- 6. Professional Delivery:**
 - Open the Export Wizard, select **Screenplay**, enable the **Professional Title Page**, and generate your **.fdx** and **.pdf** files.

14. Workflow 2: Conceptual Migration (Obsidian / JSON Canvas)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. .canvas File Import → 2. Smart Section Routing → 3. Character & Location Consolidation → 4. Step Outline & FDX Screenplay

Objective:

Transform an existing visual mind map or node network from Obsidian or Heptabase into a structured story workspace.

Step-by-Step Guide:

1. **Direct Drag-and-Drop Import:**
 - Drag your **.canvas** file from your desktop directly onto Narrando's window.
 2. **Select Routing Strategy:**
 - Choose **Intelligent Hybrid Ingestion** to direct character and location nodes to **BEING** and chronological event cards to **BECOMING**.
 3. **Ontology Consolidation:**
 - Switch to **BEING** view. Assign categories to imported entities and use **Merge Entities** to unify duplicate entries.
 4. **Step Outline Organization:**
 - Switch to **BECOMING** view. Group loose actions into scenes and establish Sequence boundaries.
 5. **Story Bible Delivery:**
 - Export a **Structured Markdown Bible with relational schemas** to document your universe before drafting dialogue.
-

15. Workflow 3: Literary Adaptation (From Prose / Novel to Screenplay)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. Prose Import → 2. AI Assisted Breakdown → 3. Character Extraction → 4. Drafting with Reference Text → 5. Step Outline & Script

Objective:

Adapt a full novel, short story, or prose treatment into an industry-standard screenplay.

Step-by-Step Guide:

1. **Prose File Import:**
 - Drag your **.docx**, **.pdf**, or **.txt** file into Narrando and select the **Prose (Master Container)** strategy.
2. **AI Assisted Breakdown:**
 - Select book chapters and click **Break Down (✨)**. The AI fragments the narrative into distinct dramatic actions.
3. **Global Character Extraction:**
 - Run **Entity Extraction with Global Assignment** to catalog all mentioned characters and link them across their respective scenes.

4. **Live Cross-Referencing with Original Text (Fossil):**
 - While drafting dialogue in the Manuscript, load the **Original Text (Fossil)** widget in the Quad-Dock to view the original prose side-by-side in read-only mode.
 5. **Adaptation Step Outline Export:**
 - Export an **Outline Treatment in PDF** to review the adaptation structure with rights holders and producers.
-

16. Workflow 4: Dramatic Consulting & Script Doctoring (Audit & Rewrite)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. FDX / Fountain Script Import → 2. AI Tension Diagnostics → 3. Lexical & Cast Focus → 4. Surgical Rewrite → 5. Executive Dossier

Objective:

Evaluate dramatic rhythm, emotional pacing, and character consistency in a finished script during rewrite phases.

Step-by-Step Guide:

1. **Direct Script Import:**
 - Drag your **.fdx** or **.fountain** file into Narrando. The script opens immediately ready for work.
 2. **Run Script Doctor Audit:**
 - Launch the audit. The system scores the tension of every action and outputs a qualitative diagnostic breakdown.
 3. **Identify Valleys in Heatmap & Timeline:**
 - Toggle **Heatmap Mode (🔥)** on the board to spot low-conflict flat stretches (coded in cool greens/blues) that require heightened stakes.
 4. **Focused Rewriting:**
 - In the Manuscript, toggle **Lexical Focus (Dialogue Only)** to audit dialogue voice and conversational cadence.
 - Use **Cast Focus** to track the protagonist or antagonist exclusively and verify motive consistency.
 - Leave revision notes in the **Marginalia** widget for each scene.
 5. **Diagnostic Delivery:**
 - Export an **Executive Analytics Dossier** with tension graphs and recommendations for the production team.
-

17. Workflow 5: Industrial Pre-Production &

Breakdown (For Line Producers & ADs)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. Approved Script Import → 2. Breakdown Sheet Review → 3. DOOD Matrix Audit → 4. Workload Analysis → 5. CSV / ZIP Export

Objective:

Convert an approved screenplay into a quantified, budget-optimized production shooting plan.

Step-by-Step Guide:

- 1. Production Asset Verification:**
 - Open the Ontology Canvas and ensure all picture vehicles, locations, and special props are classified accurately.
- 2. Generate Breakdown Sheets:**
 - Open **Machina Analytica** () and navigate to the **Breakdown Sheet** tab.
 - Review departmental tags (Cast, Extras, Props, SFX/VFX, Wardrobe, Makeup).
- 3. Audit Day-out-of-Days (DOOD):**
 - Open the **DOOD** matrix to examine work, hold, and drop days (*Work / Hold / Drop*) for every cast member.
 - Identify dead hold days and optimize shooting order to reduce talent costs.
- 4. Workload Evaluation:**
 - Review the **Workload View** to audit Day/Night ratios and total pages and eighths per scene.
- 5. Production Export:**
 - Download the **Breakdown Sheet in CSV** and the complete package for department heads.

18. Workflow 6: Writers' Room & Series Development (TV Series & Story Bible)

Workflow Pipeline: 1. Story Bible in BEING → 2. Season Outline in BECOMING → 3. Room Snapshots in Vault → 4. Pitch Deck Export

Objective:

Architect the complete story universe of a television series and outline the dramatic arcs for an entire season.

Step-by-Step Guide:

- 1. Story Bible Construction in BEING:**

- Map faction politics, family trees, and dynamic alliances on the Ontology Canvas.
 - Complete character backstories, secrets, and motivations inside Entity Sheets.
2. **Season Structure in BECOMING:**
- Create a **Scene Group** for each episode (e.g., "*Episode 101 - Pilot*", "*Episode 102*").
 - Draw causal connector lines to trace serialized A-plots and episodic B/C-plots across episodes.
3. **Writers' Room Version Control:**
- At the end of each room session, record a **Protected Snapshot** (🔒) in the Time Machine with a clear label (e.g., "*Season Board - Room Session 14*").
4. **Pitch Deck Export:**
- Export the **Story Bible / Universe in structured format** for network, studio, and streaming platform pitches.

APPENDIX

A. Master Keyboard Shortcuts Table

Navigation & Workspaces

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + K	Open the global Command Palette (workspaces, tools, and instant search).
Ctrl + F	Contextual search (continuous text in Manuscript / spatial search on 2D canvases).
Ctrl + 1	Switch to Manuscript view.
Ctrl + 2	Switch to Causal Board (BECOMING) view.
Ctrl + 3	Switch to Ontology (BEING) view.
Ctrl + 4	Switch to DUAL split-screen view.
Ctrl + 5	Switch to Machina Analytica view.
Shift + Z	Fit Timeline to screen (<i>Fit to Screen</i>).
Escape	Clear active selection / Close open floating popovers and modals.

Editing & Manuscript

Shortcut	Action
Tab	Autocomplete scene headings (INT. , EXT.) or time tokens in suggestions.
Enter	Confirm character suggestion or create a new Action (paragraph).
Backspace	At the beginning of an empty paragraph, merge with the preceding Action.
Ctrl + Enter / Cmd + Enter	Create a brand-new Scene immediately following the current one.
↑ / ↓	Navigate between floating autocomplete suggestion options.
Ctrl + A	Select all text or all cards on the active canvas.

Causal Board & Structure

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + N	Create a new Action (On board or in text).
Ctrl + D	Duplicate the selected action or group (<i>Smart Paste</i> position).
M	Merge selected actions into one.
Supr / Delete	Open dialog to remove from board or permanently delete.
Shift + Drag	Elastic marquee multi-selection of cards.

History & Security

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + S	Save changes and register a manual snapshot in the Time Vault.
Ctrl + Z	Undo the last change (<i>Local Undo</i> in text if typing, or <i>Global Undo</i> for structure).
Ctrl + Shift + Z / Ctrl + Y	Redo the last undone change.

B. Canonical Narrando Glossary

- **Action:** The atomic unit of dramatic transformation, causality, and storytelling weight.
- **Auto-Save Indicator:** Real-time visual feedback on the top bar showing when changes are safely saved to disk.
- **BECOMING:** The domain of time, chronological sequence, causal step outlining, and tension modulation.
- **BEING:** The domain of ontology, worldbuilding, character lore, and relational networks.
- **Cast Focus:** Selective display filter in the Manuscript that isolates the dialogue lines and scenes of a specific character.
- **Day-out-of-Days (DOOD):** Production scheduling matrix auditing work, hold, and release days for every cast member.
- **Entity:** Any persistent narrative asset within the story universe (Character, Location, Object, Faction, or Concept).
- **Fossils (Widget):** Modular Quad-Dock widget with a bipartite architecture: houses the **Original Text** of the active scene for reference and atomic restoration (Top Zone), and the **Morgue** for quarantined omitted scenes in production (Bottom Zone).
- **Heatmap (Thermographic Mode):** Board visualization overlay tinting cards according to their dramatic conflict score (cool green to fiery red).
- **Intelligent Autocompletion:** Real-time contextual suggestions for sluglines, time tokens, and character names.
- **Law of Natural Expansion:** Smart board layout behavior that smoothly pushes lower elements down when cards expand or move, preventing overlaps.
- **Lexical Focus:** Structural filter in the Manuscript to inspect Dialogue Only, Action Only, or Sluglines Only.
- **MANUSCRIPT:** Continuous literary screenwriting canvas formatted in Courier Prime typography.
- **Marginal Revision Asterisks (*):** Standard WGA/PGA guild cut marks placed in the far-right margin of screenplay pages to signal modified, added, or deleted lines during active shooting revisions.
- **Marginalia:** Scratchpad system for timeless notes attached to scenes without altering screenplay duration.
- **Morgue (Omitted Scenes):** Dedicated quarantine zone housed inside the Fossils widget where omitted scenes reside in production, allowing one-click in-place restoration.
- **Quad-Dock:** Modular 4-quadrant panel architecture allowing users to dock up to 9 specialized widgets.
- **Sandbox (Holding Bay):** Holding space where action cards float freely without affecting chronological order or the tension curve.
- **Script Lock (Production Mode):** Pre-production state freezing screenplay scene numbers, enforcing alphanumeric *A-Scenes*, and enabling the non-destructive omitted scene protocol.
- **Soft Sync:** Design principle ensuring real-time harmony between 2D spatial outlining and 1D literary writing.

- **Script Doctor:** Artificial intelligence assistant that audits screenplay tension and flags pacing irregularities.
- **Time Machine (Vault):** Historical repository of self-contained project snapshots for non-destructive version control and instant rollback.
- **Watermarks (Dynamic Confidentiality):** Diagonal semi-transparent watermark printed across all PDF pages with customized recipient name, copy ID, and emission date.